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DDS MARINE WEEKLY

MARITIME INTELLIGENCE

T A N K E R S | E N E R G Y | S T S | C O M P L I A N C E

Insight. Safety. Excellence.

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Executive Market Dashboard

Market snapshot: 28 August 2026 | oilprice.com, Ship & Bunker, Hellenic Shipping News and Baltic Exchange data

BRENT CRUDE US\$88.57/bbl ▼ off four-day high, still >US\$88	WTI CRUDE US\$82.25/bbl — broadly flat on the day	SINGAPORE VLSFO US\$781.00/mt ▼ US\$36.00 d/d
BALTIC DIRTY TANKER INDEX 2,801 pts ▼ 50 pts, 27 Aug	BALTIC CLEAN TANKER INDEX 1,353 pts ▲ 2 pts, 27 Aug	VLCC TCE US\$332,541/d ▼ US\$907 on the day

DDS VIEW — The tone this week is cautiously different from Issue 004. Kpler's count of Hormuz transits stayed thin at five vessels on 25 August, all moving under Iran's own "Unilateral Scheme," but Fars News now reports Iran and Oman have reached the outline of a deal on managed passage, with Tehran's IRGC spokesman saying the Strait could reopen if Washington "stops obstructing the process." Separately, and more directly relevant to our region, Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore issued a joint statement on 25 August reaffirming their commitment to keep the Straits of Malacca and Singapore open under UNCLOS transit-passage rules — an explicit response to the Hormuz situation. We have not identified a new crew casualty or vessel seizure in the reporting window. Freight, however, has not cooled: VLCC TCE at US\$332,541/day is materially above Issue 004's US\$266,512/day print a week ago, even as the day-on-day change was slightly negative. Scarcity of willing tonnage, not fresh demand, remains the driver.

This Week at a Glance

- **Diplomacy:** Iran and Oman are reported close to a framework for managed Hormuz transit; the US position and any binding terms remain unconfirmed.
- **Regional pledge:** Malaysia, Singapore and Indonesia jointly reaffirmed the Straits of Malacca and Singapore will stay open under international law — a direct response to Hormuz-driven chokepoint anxiety.
- **Container shipping:** MSC, Maersk/Hapag-Lloyd (Gemini) and the Ocean Alliance are each reinstating partial Suez/Red Sea routings; full normalisation is not expected before end-2026.
- **Oil:** Brent US\$88.57/bbl, WTI US\$82.25/bbl on 28 August — softer than the mid-week peak (Brent above US\$93 on 25 Aug) as Hormuz de-escalation hopes build.
- **Freight:** VLCC TCE US\$332,541/day, up sharply from Issue 004's US\$266,512/day despite a small day-on-day pullback; TD2 (ME Gulf/Singapore) at Ws630.56, worth US\$670,287/day.



CEO Market Commentary

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC — Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

“A quieter week is not the same as a settled one. We should read it that way.”

After the week we recorded in Issue 004, I am glad to have less to report on the human cost side of this crisis. We have not identified a fresh casualty or seizure in the seven days to 28 August. That is genuinely good news, and I do not want to bury it under caveats. But a quieter week is not the same as a settled one, and owners should not read the calm as a green light.

What has actually changed is diplomatic positioning, not operational reality. Iran's state media is reporting that Tehran and Oman have reached the outline of an understanding on managed transit, and the IRGC's own spokesman has said the Strait could reopen if the United States “stops obstructing the process.” That is a negotiating posture, not a signed agreement, and Kpler's own count still shows only five vessels transiting Hormuz on 25 August, every one of them moving under Iran's self-declared Unilateral Scheme rather than any internationally recognised transit right. OFAC's own alert, updated on 24 August, continues to warn our industry against paying Iranian “toll” or permit demands for safe passage. Nothing about the underlying legal conflict for owners has been resolved; the volume of public noise around it has simply increased.

The development I would ask every reader to sit with is closer to home. On 25 August, Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore jointly reaffirmed that the Straits of Malacca and Singapore will stay open under the transit-passage provisions of UNCLOS. Singapore's Transport Minister called it a reminder that “open sea lanes can never be taken for granted.” That statement exists because our region is now absorbing meaningful redirected tonnage from operators unwilling to test Hormuz, and because the eyes of the shipping world are increasingly on how well we handle that responsibility. TD2, Middle East Gulf to Singapore, remains one of the most valuable crude routes on the Baltic board this week at US\$670,287/day. That value is not an accident of geography; it is a vote of confidence in this corridor that we have to keep earning.

My instruction to our teams is unchanged from Issue 004: treat every Hormuz-linked nomination as an owner-level decision, not a master's judgement call, and keep our own STS and screening standards visibly ahead of the corridor everyone else is avoiding. A calmer week is the right moment to tighten discipline, not relax it.

Capt. Dinesh Naidu KC

Founder & Chairman, DDS Marine Group

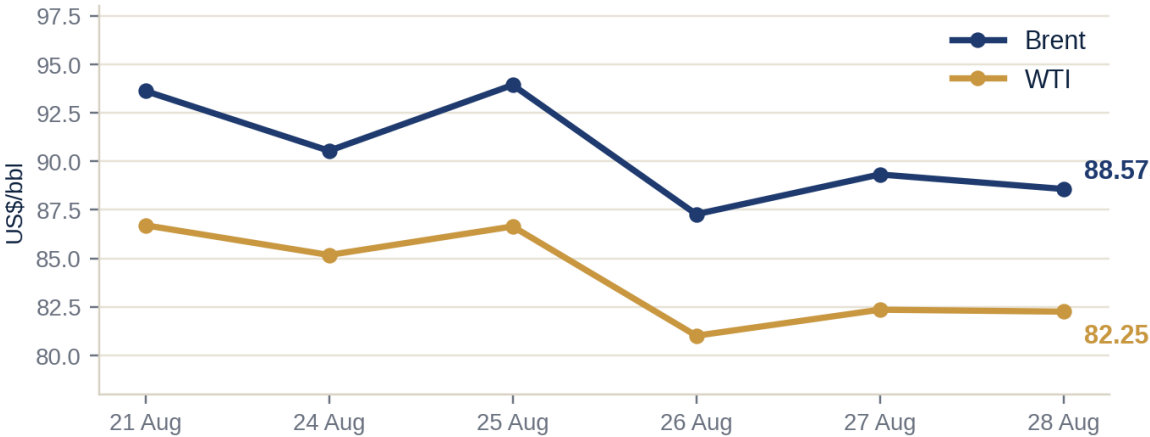
Publication Principle — Independent operational commentary based on publicly available market information from oilprice.com, Ship & Bunker, Hellenic Shipping News, the Baltic Exchange and OFAC/Treasury public releases. No vessel incident is reported in this issue's window beyond what is attributed below; DDS does not estimate or infer incidents that are not sourced.



Global Oil Market

Prices and the week's directional move, per oilprice.com and Ship & Bunker daily series

Indicator	Latest	Reading
Brent crude	US\$88.57/bbl	Live indication, 28 Aug; down from a mid-week peak above US\$93 (25 Aug) as Hormuz de-escalation hopes build.
WTI crude	US\$82.25/bbl	Broadly flat on the day; down from ~US\$86 earlier in the week.
Brent 21–28 Aug range	US\$87.27–93.93/bbl	Six-session range per Ship & Bunker daily close series and live indications.



Source: Ship & Bunker daily close series and oilprice.com live indications, 21–28 Aug 2026.

Market Interpretation

Oil has pulled back from mid-week highs as the diplomatic tone around Hormuz has softened. Brent touched US\$93.93 on 25 August — still inside the elevated range that has prevailed since the Islamabad MoU lapsed in mid-August — before easing to US\$88.57 by 28 August. Reporting this week frames the move as traders pricing a real, if unconfirmed, chance of a managed-transit arrangement between Iran and Oman, rather than any change in physical flows: Kpler's own transit count has not meaningfully recovered.

Separately, oilprice.com reports that Asian oil imports via Hormuz remain weak even as some outlets claim a surge in transits — a reminder that headline traffic figures and delivered-cargo volumes are not the same thing, and that our readers should treat any single transit count as directional rather than definitive.

DDS BASE CASE — We treat this week's pullback as sentiment-driven, not structural. Until Iran and Oman produce a binding, verifiable transit framework — and Kpler's transit counts recover in step — we expect Brent to remain rangebound in the high-US\$80s to low-US\$90s, with sharp two-way risk around any diplomatic headline.

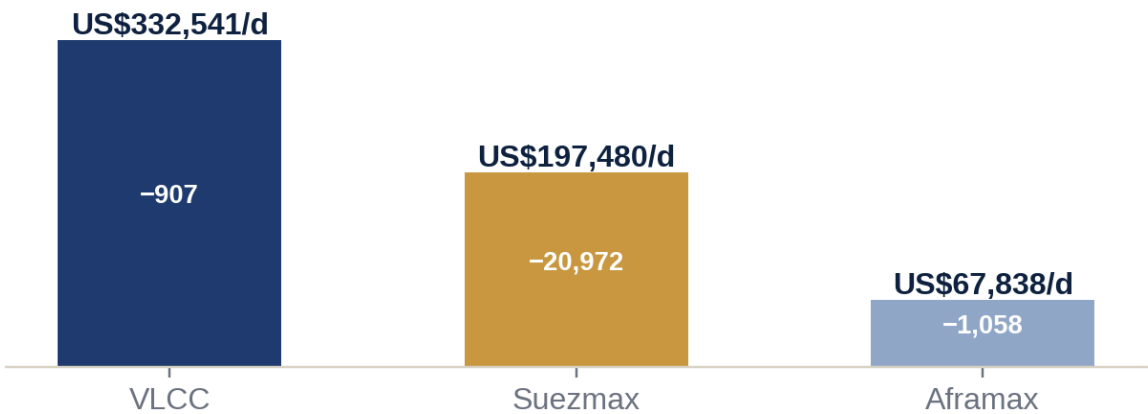
Commercial effect on shipping: Bunker costs have eased in step with crude this week (see Bunker Market, p.7), offering some relief on voyage economics. Owners should still treat any voyage budget assuming near-term Hormuz normalisation as speculative until a framework is confirmed in writing.



Crude Tanker Market

VLCC, Suezmax and Aframax — Baltic Exchange, 27 August 2026

Segment	Current Tone	Primary Driver
VLCC	Very firm, easing modestly	TD2 (ME Gulf/Singapore) leads the board at Ws630.56; scarcity premium persists
Suezmax	Softening broadly	TD6 (Black Sea/Med) down 31.78 Ws points; TD20 (WAF/UK-Cont) down 26.39
Aframax	Mixed	TD8 (Kuwait/Spore) near-flat; TD25 (USG/ARA) down sharply



Crude tanker TCE, US\$/day, Baltic Exchange print 27 August 2026. Change vs. prior print shown inside each bar.

VLCC

VLCC remains the strongest crude segment by a wide margin. TD2 (ME Gulf/Singapore) printed Ws630.56 (+2.56), worth US\$670,287/day (+US\$4,657) — still the single most valuable route on the board and the one most directly relevant to our Southeast Asia readership. TD3C (ME Gulf/China) rose to Ws623.33 (+3.89, US\$647,043/day) while TD15 (WAF/China) eased to Ws204.94 (–9.56, US\$179,600/day). Blended VLCC TCE across TD3C, TD15 and TD22 stands at US\$332,541/day, down a modest US\$907 on the print but still far above the US\$266,512/day recorded in Issue 004 a week earlier — the scarcity premium from Chinese fleet withdrawal has not unwound even as headlines soften.

Suezmax

Suezmax pulled back hardest this week: TD6 (Black Sea/Med) eased to Ws553.89 (–31.78, still worth US\$284,249/day) and TD20 (WAF/UK-Cont) to Ws328.33 (–26.39, US\$110,711/day). Blended Suezmax TCE fell to US\$197,480/day (–US\$20,972), the sharpest segment move on the board. TD23 (ME Gulf/Med) held essentially flat at Ws484.44, and TD33 (US Gulf/ARA) softened to Ws251.11 (–31.67, US\$103,014/day).

Aframax

Aframax was mixed: TD8 (Kuwait/Singapore) held near-flat at Ws360.42 (–0.41, US\$94,737/day) and TD14 (SE Asia/ EC Australia) firmed slightly to Ws196.88 (+1.88, US\$42,152/day), while TD25 (USG/ARA) fell sharply to Ws201.67 (–28.61, US\$39,929/day). Blended Aframax TCE eased to US\$67,838/day (–US\$1,058).

DDS VIEW — This week is a Suezmax pullback against a VLCC segment easing only at the margin: the market is trimming risk premium fastest where it was thinnest. Suezmax lacks VLCC's structural scarcity story, where Chinese operators are still reported holding capacity out of the corridor. Until that withdrawal reverses, we would not read this week's VLCC dip as a broader correction.



Clean & Product Tankers

LR2, LR1, MR and Handysize — Baltic Exchange, 27 August 2026

Segment	This Week's Signal	Watch
LR2	TC1 (ME Gulf/Japan) Ws540.00 (−0.56), US\$147,487/day (+US\$881)	Whether Gulf loading access becomes the binding constraint on employment.
LR1	TC5 (ME Gulf/Japan) Ws579.38 (+1.25), US\$112,472/day	TC8 (ME Gulf/UK-Cont) firm at US\$90,759/day.
MR	Pacific Basket US\$40,524/day (+US\$1,629); Atlantic Basket US\$22,939/day (−US\$1,382)	Asian MR strength vs. Atlantic softness — a reversal of the Issue 004 pattern.
Handysize	TC6 (Algeria/Euro Med) US\$8,489/day (+US\$578); TC23 (ARA/UK-Cont) US\$8,889/day (+US\$809)	Both routes firmer, still the smallest-earning clean segment.

The Pacific/Atlantic Rotation

The clean complex has rotated since Issue 004. The MR Pacific Basket rose to US\$40,524/day (+US\$1,629), driven by firmer intra-Asia routes — TC7 (Singapore/EC Australia) up 6.07 Ws points to Ws315.00, and TC10 (S Korea/NoPac WC) up to \$64.406/mt (+US\$2.109). The MR Atlantic Basket, by contrast, eased to US\$22,939/day (−US\$1,382) as TC14 (USG/UK-Cont) fell 12.14 Ws points to Ws213.57 and TC18 (US Gulf/Brazil) eased to Ws287.86 (−10.72). That is close to a mirror image of the pattern recorded in Issue 004, when Atlantic routes were the strong side of the board.

LR2 and LR1 held broadly firm on Middle East Gulf/Japan routings — TC1 essentially flat at Ws540.00 and TC5 up modestly to Ws579.38 — while TC20 (ME Gulf/UK-Cont, LR2) softened to a US\$9,243,750 lumpsum (−US\$25,000), worth US\$116,681/day.

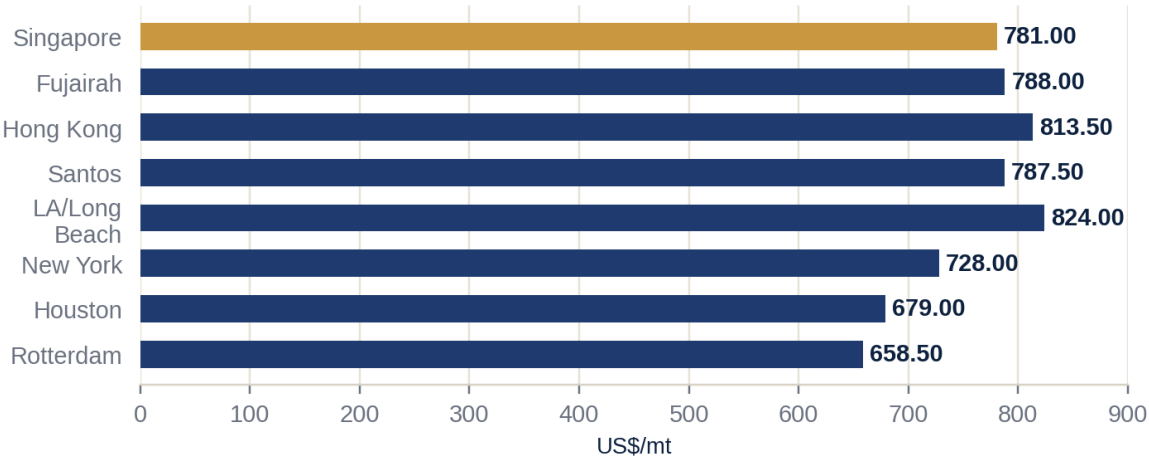
DDS VIEW — A firmer Pacific basket alongside a softer Atlantic one is consistent with product demand rotating toward North Asia even as the acute Hormuz narrative has quieted for now. For owners with MR tonnage able to trade either basin, this week's numbers argue for keeping options open on repositioning rather than committing early to an Atlantic programme on the strength of last week's rates.



Bunker Market — Singapore & Global Benchmark

Current indications in US\$/mt, Ship & Bunker (shipandbunker.com), 28 August 2026

Grade	Singapore	Day Change
VLSFO	US\$781.00/mt	-US\$36.00
MGO	US\$1,139.50/mt	-US\$70.00
IFO380	US\$628.50/mt	-US\$26.00



Singapore vs. other bunkering hubs, VLSFO US\$/mt, 28 August 2026. Singapore highlighted gold as DDS's home reference port. Source: Ship & Bunker.

Interpretation

All three Singapore grades eased sharply this week in step with the softer crude complex — VLSFO down US\$36.00 to US\$781.00/mt, the largest single-day move we have tracked in recent issues. Singapore's VLSFO now sits below Fujairah (US\$788.00/mt), Hong Kong (US\$813.50/mt) and LA/Long Beach (US\$824.00/mt), continuing to hold a competitive position among the major Asia/Pacific hubs. Rotterdam remains the cheapest of the eight hubs tracked at US\$658.50/mt.

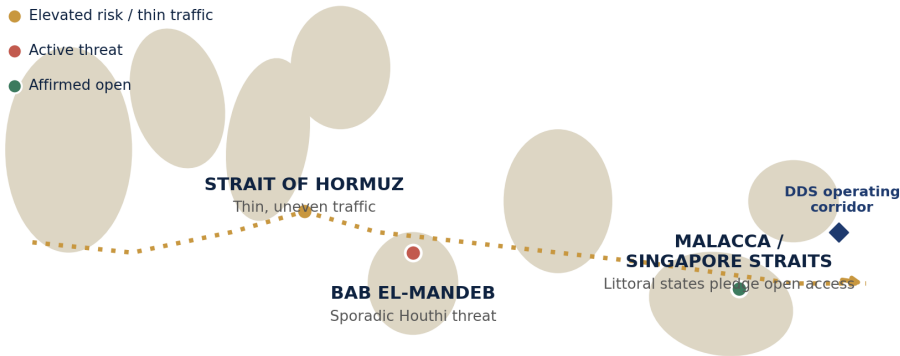
The Global 4 Ports Average VLSFO fell to US\$726.50/mt (-US\$22.50), and the Global 20 Ports Average to US\$794.50/mt (-US\$17.00) — a broad-based pullback consistent with this week's softer crude prices rather than a Singapore-specific development.

Compliance cost note: EU ETS-linked compliance costs move with the EUA price and should continue to be stated explicitly in bunker and freight clauses for any EU-linked call; we will resume tracking the specific EUA print once a same-week source is confirmed.



Geopolitical & Route Risk

Hormuz, Bab el-Mandeb and Malacca — three chokepoints, three different trajectories this week



Schematic for illustrative purposes only — not to scale / not for navigation

Schematic overview of the three chokepoints most relevant to DDS readers. Not to scale; for illustration only.

Area	Current Signal	Commercial Consequence
Strait of Hormuz	Traffic still thin (5 vessels, 25 Aug, per Kpler) but Iran-Oman reportedly close to a managed-transit framework.	No change yet to the underlying legal conflict for owners; OFAC's 24 Aug alert still warns against paying Iranian transit tolls.
Bab el-Mandeb	Sporadic Houthi threat persists; no new confirmed incident identified this window.	Continued elevated war-risk premium on Red Sea routings.
Malacca & Singapore Straits	Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore jointly reaffirmed open, safe transit under UNCLOS on 25 Aug.	Reinforces the region's position as the credible alternative corridor; raises the bar on our own screening and STS standards.

Where the Iran-Oman Talks Actually Stand

Iran's semi-official Fars News Agency reports that Tehran and Oman have spent the past month in negotiations and reached conclusions accepted by both sides, with an IRGC spokesperson saying the Strait could reopen if the United States “stops obstructing the process” and accepts Iran's conditions. That is a long way from a signed, verifiable agreement, and the same reporting notes an Indian tanker, the Haana, turned back from the southern Oman Corridor after an IRGC warning on the same day the talks were described as advanced — a reminder that the Unilateral Scheme, not any negotiated right, still governs practical passage.

Container Shipping's Cautious Return to Suez

Separately, container majors are testing a return to the Red Sea/Suez route after roughly three years of diversion around Africa. MSC has officially announced a partial return; Maersk/Hapag-Lloyd's Gemini network and the CMA CGM/ COSCO/Evergreen/OOCL Ocean Alliance are each running partial Suez services. Vespucci Maritime's Lars Jensen suggested normalisation is plausible by end-2026, though some services will likely keep routing via Africa to absorb released capacity.

DDS RISK LEVEL: ELEVATED (down from CRITICAL in Issue 004). No new crew casualty or vessel seizure identified this window; however Iran's Unilateral Scheme still governs Hormuz passage and no binding framework exists. DDS recommends maintaining current owner-level authorisation and war-risk protocols pending written confirmation of any Iran-Oman terms.



Sanctions & Compliance Watch

Actionable controls for fixtures and STS operations

Developments — Week Ending 28 August 2026

OFAC alert update, 24 August: Treasury's Office of Foreign Assets Control issued an update to its earlier alert on "Sanctions Risks of Iranian Demands for Strait of Hormuz Passage," refreshing guidance first issued 1 May 2026 in light of continued Iranian demands for transit permits and "toll" payments. OFAC continues to strongly encourage maritime service providers to conduct enhanced due diligence on any vessel attempting a Hormuz transit. The same day, OFAC issued a "Notice of Suspension of Certain Iranian Transactions and Sanctions Regulations General Licenses" — owners should confirm with counsel whether any general licence they rely on is affected.

Standing designation activity: On 29 July 2026, OFAC designated PGMIC and Hormuz Safe under Executive Order 13902 for operating in the financial sector of the Iranian economy — a reminder that Iran-linked designations continue on a rolling basis independent of the diplomatic headlines.

This creates direct legal conflict for owners that has not changed since Issue 004: paying a fee demanded by Iran's asserted permit-and-toll regime may create sanctions exposure; refusing may invite the kind of seizure risk recorded in our last issue. Obtain written owner and insurer positions before nominating tonnage to the Strait, and do not treat improved diplomatic tone as a substitute for a confirmed framework.

Control	Minimum Action
Transit fee position	Maintain the written, owner-level decision on Iranian transit permits/tolls established in Issue 004; do not relax pending a signed framework.
General licence check	Confirm with sanctions counsel whether the 24 Aug OFAC notice affects any general licence your operations rely on.
Riau / OPL screening	Continue enhanced due diligence at Malaysian and Indonesian outer port limits, consistent with prior reporting on deceptive-practice risk in the region.
Vessel screening	Screen IMO, current and former names, flag history, ownership, management, operator and ISM company on every nomination.
Record preservation	Keep screenshots, reports, approvals, emails, SOF and operational instructions in the job file.

Editorial & Verification Note: *DDS Marine Group publishes vessel names, IMO numbers and designation detail only where attributable to a named primary source (OFAC/Treasury, or reputable trade press citing named trackers). Readers should verify any specific vessel against the current OFAC SDN list and their own screening provider before acting.*



Weekly Incident & Risk Watch

Confirmed developments, 21–28 August 2026

No new confirmed crew casualty or vessel seizure has been identified in this reporting window across the sources DDS tracks (oilprice.com, Ship & Bunker, Hellenic Shipping News). This is a materially calmer week than Issue 004, which recorded the MINOAN DIGNITY fatality and the AMARA seizure. DDS does not estimate or reconstruct incident data we cannot source, and will continue reporting the standing incident log only when a new confirmed event is attributable to a named tracker.

What We Are Still Watching

- Whether Iran's asserted permit-and-toll regime results in any further vessel detention as the Iran-Oman talks continue.
- Whether the 25 August Haana turn-back near the southern Oman Corridor is an isolated event or the start of a pattern under an active Unilateral Scheme.
- Whether COSCO and China Merchants maintain their reported withdrawal of 100+ VLCCs from Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb, or begin a phased return.
- P&I club and war-risk underwriter guidance following any confirmed terms of an Iran-Oman transit framework.

Ship Recycling & Demolition

Best Oasis published its weekly recycling market report on 27 August 2026, noting that *“the Indian market remains firm, with keen interest from buyers for fresh tonnage”* and that local market conditions had strengthened during the week. The full report was not accessible to DDS at time of publication (paywalled), so we are not able to reproduce specific per-ltd pricing this issue. We will resume full demolition-market coverage once we can source and verify the complete weekly figures.

Section note: *This section replaces the Vessel Security & Incident Log introduced in Issue 004. The standing log returns in full whenever a new confirmed incident is attributable to a named primary source; in a quiet week, DDS will not populate it with placeholder or estimated entries.*



Southeast Asia & STS Operations

Malaysia · Singapore · Indonesia · Thailand · Vietnam — the Malacca-to-Pengerang corridor

This is the most consequential week for our home region since we began this publication. On 25 August, Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore — the Littoral States of the Straits of Malacca and Singapore — issued a joint statement reaffirming their “shared commitment to keep the Straits open and safe for international shipping,” explicitly affirming the Straits’ status under UNCLOS transit-passage provisions. Singapore’s Transport Minister, Jeffrey Siow, told an Indonesia-Malaysia-Singapore forum that “events in the Middle East this year reminded the world that open sea lanes can never be taken for granted,” adding that the three states “will endeavour to keep the Straits of Malacca and Singapore free, open and safe for international shipping.”

Market	Why It Matters This Week
Malaysia	Home to Port Klang, Malacca, Muar, Linggi and the Johor STS/bunkering corridor. The 25 Aug joint statement puts our home waters directly in the frame of the global Hormuz conversation.
Singapore	TD2 (ME Gulf/Singapore) remains the strongest dirty tanker route on the board at Ws630.56, worth US\$670,287/day.
Indonesia	Co-signatory to the 25 Aug pledge; Batam and Karimun remain active in STS and bunkering.
Thailand	Gulf of Thailand distribution continues to benefit from trade diversion as a secondary regional routing option.
Vietnam	Growing product-import demand; a bellwether for intra-Asia clean tanker and MR patterns as the Pacific MR basket firms.

STS & Marine-Services Operating Standard

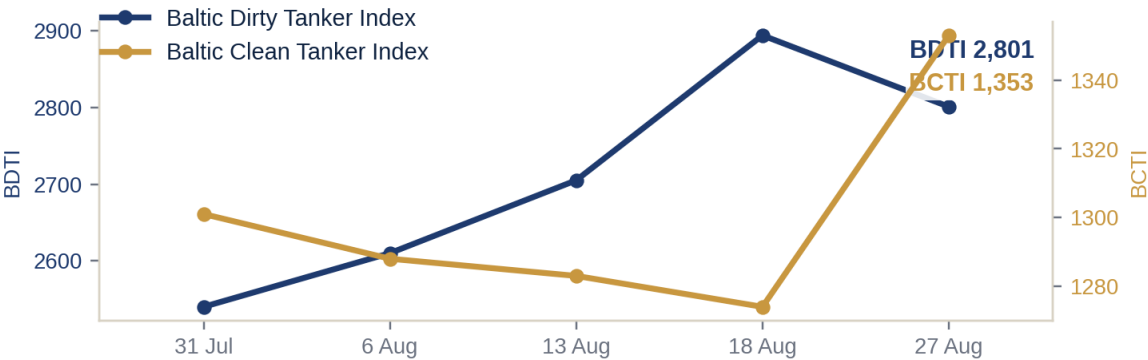
Operational Pillar	DDS Standard
Planning	Job-specific JPO, risk assessment, mooring plan, weather limits, communications plan and emergency response.
Vessel suitability	Compatibility review covering freeboard, manifold, fenders, hoses, mooring arrangement, vetting and cargo system.
Counterparty & identity	IMO verification against scrapping records; beneficial ownership; AIS dark-period review; cargo-origin documentary chain.
Documentation	Accurate NOR, SOF, checklists, pumping records, delay evidence, photographs and final operation report.

DDS VIEW — A formal, named pledge from three governments to keep our home corridor open is not something we should treat as routine. It is a public statement that the world is watching how Southeast Asia handles the volume redirected away from Hormuz. The commercial case for rigorous, documented, verifiable STS execution has never been stronger, and this week gives us a public benchmark — set by our own governments — to be measured against.



Freight & Rate Signals

Baltic Exchange dirty, clean, LPG and LNG indices, 27 August 2026 (Thursday) — as reported by Baltic Exchange



Baltic Dirty Tanker Index (left axis) vs. Baltic Clean Tanker Index (right axis), trailing five prints.

Baltic Dirty Tanker Index — 2,801 (–50)

Route	Rate	US\$/day
TD2 — ME Gulf / Singapore (VLCC, 270k)	Ws630.56 (+2.56)	670,287 (+4,657)
TD3C — ME Gulf / China (VLCC, 270k)	Ws623.33 (+3.89)	647,043 (+6,141)
TD15 — WAF / China (VLCC, 260k)	Ws204.94 (–9.56)	179,600 (–8,519)
VLCC TCE (TD3C, TD15 & TD22)	—	332,541 (–907)
TD6 — Black Sea / Med (Suezmax, 135k)	Ws553.89 (–31.78)	284,249 (–26,758)
TD20 — WAF / UK-Cont (Suezmax, 130k)	Ws328.33 (–26.39)	110,711 (–15,185)
TD33 — US Gulf / ARA (Suezmax, 145k)	Ws251.11 (–31.67)	103,014 (–22,161)
Suezmax TCE (TD6 & TD20)	—	197,480 (–20,972)
TD8 — Kuwait / Singapore (Aframax, 80k)	Ws360.42 (–0.41)	94,737 (+1,073)
TD14 — SE Asia / EC Australia (Aframax, 80k)	Ws196.88 (+1.88)	42,152 (+1,761)
Aframax TCE (TD7, TD8, TD14, TD19, TD25, TD26)	—	67,838 (–1,058)

Baltic Clean Tanker Index — 1,353 (+2)

Route	Rate	US\$/day
TC1 — ME Gulf / Japan (LR2, 75k)	Ws540.00 (–0.56)	147,487 (+881)
TC5 — ME Gulf / Japan (LR1, 55k)	Ws579.38 (+1.25)	112,472 (+1,235)
TC14 — USG / UK-Cont (MR, 38k)	Ws213.57 (–12.14)	19,742 (–1,848)
TC18 — US Gulf / Brazil (MR, 38k)	Ws262.14 (–10.72)	28,725 (–1,357)
MR Atlantic Basket	—	22,939 (–1,382)
MR Pacific Basket	—	40,524 (+1,629)



Baltic LPG & LNG

Route	Rate	US\$/day
Baltic LPG Index	17,830 (−351)	—
BLPG1 — ME Gulf / Japan (44k)	\$217.750/mt (−1.500)	210,291 (−3,651)
BLPG3 — US Gulf / Japan (44k)	\$267.167/mt (−5.334)	154,458 (−2,673)
BLNG1_74g — Gladstone / Tokyo RV	—	66,100 (−400)
BLNG3_74g — Sabine / Tokyo RV	—	42,000 (0)

DDS VIEW — TD2 is again the number to take away, worth an incremental US\$4,657/day and still the single most valuable route we track. But look beneath the index-level BDTI dip (−50 points): VLCC TCE at US\$332,541/day is up substantially from Issue 004's US\$266,512/day print, while Suezmax has pulled back hard (−US\$20,972). The dirty complex is bifurcating by segment, not moving as one block — a pattern worth tracking route-by-route rather than reading off the headline index alone.



Seven-Day Outlook: 29 Aug – 4 Sep 2026

29 August – 4 September 2026

Market	Base Case	Upside Risk	Downside Risk
Crude oil	Rangebound high-US\$80s to low-US\$90s Brent as markets await confirmation of any Iran-Oman terms.	A confirmed, verifiable transit framework pushing Brent lower on eased supply risk.	Any breakdown in talks, or a fresh incident, pushing Brent back above US\$93.
VLCC	Firm; scarcity of willing tonnage remains the binding constraint pending any Chinese fleet return.	Further owner withdrawal from the corridor tightening the willing pool further.	A confirmed framework prompting a phased Chinese return to Hormuz transits.
Suezmax	Consolidating after this week's sharp pullback.	Renewed Black Sea/CPC strike risk reviving the Atlantic substitution trade.	Continued de-escalation easing the Black Sea premium further.
Southeast Asia	Sustained premium on Gulf/Singapore routings; heightened scrutiny of regional STS practice.	Further redirected tonnage as Hormuz remains impractical for large operators.	A confirmed Hormuz framework reducing the diversion premium our region currently enjoys.

Watch List

- Whether Iran and Oman produce a written, verifiable transit framework, and how Washington responds to it.
- Whether Kpler's Hormuz transit counts begin to recover from this week's thin five-vessel daily reading.
- Whether COSCO and China Merchants signal any change to their reported withdrawal from Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb.
- Further container-shipping announcements on Suez/Red Sea route normalisation from the remaining major alliances.
- Best Oasis's full weekly demolition report, expected to be sourceable for Issue 006.

DDS CONCLUSION — Issue 004 recorded the crisis at its sharpest: a lapsed agreement, a seafarer killed, a tanker seized. Issue 005 records the first tentative steps toward de-escalation — reported Iran-Oman progress, a partial container-shipping return to Suez, and a strong regional counter-signal in the Littoral States' pledge to keep Malacca and Singapore open. None of this is confirmed enough to change our operating posture. The task for the week ahead is to watch for written terms, not headlines, while continuing to make the most of the structural advantage our region currently holds.



Methodology, Sources & Disclaimer

ISSUE 005

DDS Weekly Maritime Intelligence combines public market data, official regulatory releases, reputable news reporting and operator-focused analysis. Freight commentary is directional and does not reproduce proprietary broker assessments or subscription-only indices.

Source	Information Used
oilprice.com, 28 Aug 2026	Brent US\$88.57/bbl, WTI US\$82.25/bbl (live indications); coverage of Hormuz traffic reporting and the Malacca littoral-states statement.
Ship & Bunker (shipandbunker.com), 28 Aug 2026	Singapore, Fujairah, Rotterdam, Houston, Hong Kong, Santos, LA/Long Beach and New York VLSFO, MGO and IFO380 indications; regional averages.
Hellenic Shipping News Worldwide, 28 Aug 2026	“Hormuz transits still limited even as Iran, Oman near deal; carriers eye return to Suez route” (source: Kpler, ICIS); Best Oasis Weekly Recycling Market Report (27 Aug 2026, headline only — full report paywalled).
Baltic Exchange, 27 Aug 2026	Dirty, clean, LPG and LNG tanker index data (TD/TC/BLPG/BLNG routes), as supplied by Rishi Nath Sai / DDS Marine.
U.S. Department of the Treasury / OFAC, 24 & 29 Jul 2026	“Sanctions Risks of Iranian Demands for Strait of Hormuz Passage” alert update; Notice of Suspension of Certain Iranian Transactions and Sanctions Regulations General Licenses; PGMIC/Hormuz Safe designation.

What's changed since Issue 004 (21 August 2026): No new crew casualty or vessel seizure identified in this window. Iran and Oman are reported close to a managed-transit framework for Hormuz, though nothing is confirmed in writing and OFAC's 24 Aug alert still warns against paying Iranian transit tolls. Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore jointly reaffirmed open, safe transit through the Straits of Malacca and Singapore on 25 Aug. Brent eased from a mid-week peak above US\$93 to US\$88.57; VLCC TCE remains far above Issue 004's print despite a small day-on-day pullback. The Vessel Security & Incident Log is replaced this issue by a Weekly Incident & Risk Watch reflecting the quieter window, and returns in full when a new confirmed incident is sourced.

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